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With Vrabel, Krafts give Pats' fans a future

BEN VOLIN
COMMENTARY

Credit Robert and Jonathan Kraft — this time, they got it right.

Last year, they got it so wrong at head coach, handing the job to an unqualified Jerod Mayo without talking to any other candidates.

But the Krafts nailed it this time with Mike Vrabel, who agreed Sunday to become the Patriots' next head coach.

Vrabel was practically factory-built to be a Patriots head coach: a former player from the glory days, a member of the team's hall of

fame, and an experienced head coach with a history of success from his six years in Tennessee.

Vrabel should have been hired last year when the Patriots moved on from Bill Belichick. Instead, the Krafts stuck to their commitment to Mayo, and it resulted in a wasted 2024 season. The Patriots finished 4-13, with little to show for the season other than the promising play of rookie quarterback Drake Maye.

Firing Mayo after one year was an expensive decision for the Krafts. But the Patriots' on-field product is at its lowest point in 30 years, and Vrabel, 49, is just the man to lead the revival.

The Patriots' outlook is suddenly a lot sunnier than it had been the



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF FILE

Mike Vrabel was inducted into the Patriots Hall of Fame in 2023.

No misdirection play

Mike Vrabel was the front-runner from the start and the Patriots wasted little time hiring him. **C1.**

past two years. They have a legit coach, an exciting young quarterback, the No. 4 draft pick, and the most salary cap space in the NFL. You don't have to squint anymore to see the path back to success.

Of course, no one truly knows if Vrabel can work his magic in Foxborough the way he did in Nashville, where he went 54-45. The folks in Tennessee, where Vrabel was fired after the 2023 season for clashing with the owner and front office, like to point out that Vrabel's

VOLIN, Page C4

L.A. area bracing for more high winds

Gusts may fuel raging fires that have destroyed homes; toll of dead, missing rising

By Claire Moses, Amy Graff, and Nicholas Bogel-Burroughs

NEW YORK TIMES

The Los Angeles area braced for more high winds this week that could erode progress in controlling raging wildfires, which have destroyed thousands of homes and businesses and killed at least 24 people.

Officials said they expected the toll from the fires to rise as search teams with cadaver dogs scoured burned-out neighborhoods from the inland hills to the Pacific Coast.

At least 16 people had been reported missing as of Sunday from the areas of the two largest fires — 12 in the Eaton fire, in the Altadena and Pasadena area, and four in the Palisades fire, between Santa Monica and Malibu — Sheriff Robert Luna of Los Angeles County told reporters Sunday.

"I expect or anticipate that the number of missing persons will absolutely go up," he said. "Hour by the hour, the numbers increase."

The fires that began Tuesday just north of downtown Los Angeles have burned more than 12,000 structures.

No cause has been determined for the largest

FIRES, Page A7

►Worcester Polytechnic Institute students work on new methods to fight fires. **D1.**

'We are giving them six months where they can work solely on getting themselves healthy again, because trying to stay clean while trying to find housing and a job is very, very hard.'

ANDREW MAIER, of Boston Health Care for the Homeless Program's advisory board



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

"It felt like I could breathe again, and finally face the world with a clear mind," Rosario Malcolm-Testaverde said of his new apartment, which he shares with his pit bull in Dorchester. WellSense Health Plan paid for the stay as part of a novel experiment.

When recovery starts at home

Insurer's pilot program for high-risk drug users paid for housing. Hospitalizations plummeted.

By Chris Serres
GLOBE STAFF

Fifteen years of taking crystal methamphetamine battered Rosario Malcolm-Testaverde's mind. He heard hallucinatory voices multiple times a day and suffered bouts of paranoia so severe that he sometimes was convinced the FBI was following him. He bounced in and out of hospital emergency departments seven times, racking up more than \$200,000 in medical expenses.

For much of this period, he slept in home-

less shelters or on the streets, which contributed to his paranoia and made it impossible to stay on medications that calmed his anxiety.

Then Malcolm-Testaverde, 35, learned of an innovative new program through his insurer that would cover the cost of his housing for six months — provided he stay abstinent. For the first time in memory, he could sleep without fear that someone would roust him at night and steal his few belongings, including his medications.

"It felt like I could breathe again, and fi-

54%

reduction in emergency department visits documented by the program and a nearly 60 percent reduction in inpatient admissions to hospitals.

nally face the world with a clear mind," he said.

Malcolm-Testaverde is among 108 people with long-term addictions who had the good fortune to participate in a novel experiment in health care — one that illuminates the in-

HOUSING PROGRAM, Page A10

From foxholes to top defense, security offices

Trump's nominees share time at war, but not views

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — It was a nighttime raid gone tragically wrong, as told by Michael Waltz, in his memoir of serving as a Green Beret officer in Afghanistan.

In attempting to take out a Taliban-aligned chief at his compound, Afghan forces under Waltz's command also accidentally shot and killed the warlord's young daughter.

"I was there to create a better life for the children of Afghanistan and by extension create a safer future for my daughter. But now one was dead as a result of a mission I led," wrote Waltz. "For the first time, I could remember I started to wonder what impact we were really having."

This inflection point for Waltz typified much about the decades-long conflict known as the global war on terror: Messy geopolitics. Unintended

NOMINEES, Page A6



Rep. Michael Waltz

Olin struggles to engineer way out of woes

Well-regarded college faces president's resignation, budget problems

By Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF

Olin College, a small, highly regarded engineering school in Needham, has joined the ranks of colleges facing serious financial and leadership difficulties as it confronts a budget shortfall, concerns from an accreditor, and the resignation of its president.

Gilda A. Barabino, who became the college's first Black and first female president in July 2020 and only the second leader in its history, plans to exit at the end of the academic year, a spokesperson for Olin confirmed.

And in July, the college told the campus community it would only cover \$10,000 per student moving forward instead of providing a significantly bigger break in tuition, as it has for decades, according to an internal announcement obtained by the Globe.

"This change to the merit scholarship will alleviate operational pressure on the endowment," officials wrote, referring to the award all students had received.

OLIN, Page A10



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Gilda A. Barabino, the college's first Black and first female president, will leave her post at the end of the academic year.



A mild guess

Monday: Some sun, warmer. High 39-44, low 25-30.

Tuesday: Mix of clouds, sun. High 33-38, low 21-26.

Sunrise: 7:12. Sunset: 4:35.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C8-9.**

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High-level Israeli security and policy officials joined ceasefire talks in Qatar as the push for a deal accelerates. **A4.**

Prospect Medical Holdings filed for bankruptcy protection, further clouding the future of its hospitals in Rhode Island and Connecticut. **D1.**

Republicans reelected Amy Carnevale as chair of the state GOP. **B1.**

A guide for two-wheelers and four-wheelers to get around Boston more safely. **B1.**

The Mass. exodus of residents continues, but at a slower pace, writes Jon Chesto. **D1.**

The Celtics held off the New Orleans Pelicans, 120-119, despite miscues that almost blew a late 5-point lead. **C1.**